8 August: The governments of India and Bhutan enter into an agreement reconfirming Bhutan's status as a nation dependent on India but with a high degree of autonomy.

1 October: Mao Zedong proclaims the People's Republic of China in Beijing, ending the Chinese Civil War between the Communists and the Nationalist Chinese Kuomintang (KMT). The KMT and its followers flee to Taiwan, where the Republic of China lives on. Some KMT troops withdraw to mountainous regions in northeastern Myanmar.

1950

7 October: Communist Chinese troops enter Tibet.

November: The first contingent of Chinese troops arrives at Lhasa.

5 December: The president of India and the maharaja of Sikkim sign an agreement according to which 'Sikkim shall continue to be a Protectorate of India.'

1950–3

In the Korean War, China sends 'volunteers' to support North Korea, while India participates in the UN-backed support for South Korea.

1951

February: A detachment of the Assam Rifles, led by Ralengnao 'Bob' Khathing, enters Tawang, to secure the border with Tibet after the Chinese had occupied it.

23 May: The 17-point 'Agreement for the Peaceful Liberation of Tibet' is signed between the Chinese and a representative of Tibet's Dalai Lama.

September: The Chinese army takes control of Lhasa.

1954

January: The North-East Frontier Tract becomes the North-East Frontier Area (NEFA).

29 April: China and India sign an agreement regarding Tibet. India recognizes Tibet as a region of China. Zhou Enlai visits New Delhi and Jawaharlal Nehru visits Beijing. Relations between the two countries are close and cordial.